

4 Month Sleep Regression Guide — Action Checklist

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REFRAME THE SLEEP REGRESSION AS GROWTH

- ☐ **Reframe the Regression as Growth:** Recognize that your baby's sleep has not gone backward but has matured into adult-like sleep architecture, which represents a positive neurological milestone requiring adjustment rather than a problem to solve.
- ☐ **Understand the Four Sleep Stages:** Learn that your baby now cycles through light drowsiness, light sleep, deep sleep, and REM sleep, and that fully conscious wakings occur at cycle transitions because your baby can no longer sleep through them automatically.
- ☐ **Accept That This Is Temporary:** Accept that this phase typically lasts between two and six weeks and represents a temporary developmental season rather than a permanent change in your baby's sleep patterns.
- ☐ **Stop Blaming Yourself:** Stop believing you caused this regression because it results from normal brain development, not from anything you did wrong as a parent or any changes in your care approach.

SUPPORT SLEEP CYCLE NAVIGATION

- ☐ **Support Self-Soothing Development:** Help your baby develop the ability to navigate partial wakings between sleep cycles by offering calm, consistent responses that teach returning to sleep without full parental intervention.
- ☐ **Create Consistent Sleep Associations:** Establish predictable sleep cues and a consistent environment so your baby has clear signals that help them transition back to sleep when they wake between cycles.
- ☐ **Keep Baby From Overtiring:** Prevent overtiredness throughout the day by watching for sleep cues and maintaining age-appropriate wake windows, since accumulated fatigue makes night wakings more frequent and harder to resolve.
- ☐ **Avoid Sleep Training Methods:** Avoid extinction-based or cry-it-out methods during this specific developmental window because the 4-month regression requires understanding and support rather than training protocols.

PROTECT YOURSELF DURING THIS PHASE

- ☐ **Prioritize Your Own Recovery:** Protect your mental and physical health by sleeping in shifts with your partner, accepting help from others, and recognizing that your well-being directly affects your ability to care for your baby.
 - ☐ **Watch for Medical Complications:** Monitor your baby for signs of underlying medical issues like reflux, ear infections, or tongue-tie that could be compounding the sleep regression and require separate treatment.
 - ☐ **Differentiate Regression From Chronic Issues:** Distinguish between the temporary 4-month sleep regression and persistent sleep problems by noting that this specific phase resolves once the brain consolidates the new sleep architecture.
 - ☐ **Lower Expectations Realistically:** Lower your expectations for both yourself and your baby over the next several weeks by treating this as a pass/fail survival period rather than a time for achieving sleep perfection.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.